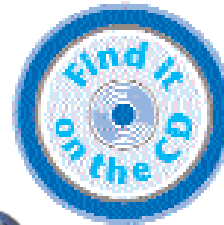




Downloads, uninterrupted

If you're on the Net, you must be spending lot of time downloading utilities and software. Downloading is ranked right up there along with e-mail and chat as the most popular online function. Keeping in mind the frustrations faced by every 56k dial-up user, download managers such as FlashGet are here to make things easier, for example, by continuing downloads even if the user gets disconnected. FlashGet—with features such as drop-zone, to which you can drag-and-drop a link to be downloaded—increases download speeds by segmenting large files into smaller chunks and downloading them from different Internet mirrors. That being said, this write up need not be any longer!

Freeware; www.amazesoft.com



Chat one, chat all

Chatting was meant to be fun, and it shouldn't be otherwise. But with friends scattered all over Yahoo!, MSN, ICQ, IRC and AIM, you should get a cross-platform messaging client that can help you manage all your accounts from a single chat application. With Trillian, importing your existing contacts from the other messaging services is child's play. Once you've done this, you'll find that it offers access to the most useful features from each of the top IMs—without making it too confusing to configure. Add to this features such as proxy and firewall support and auto archiving of chat conversations, and Trillian makes the top of the charts in the multi-platform messenger category. All this for free.

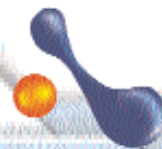
Freeware; www.ceruleanstudios.com



Scour the Web

Searching the Net for relevant information can sometimes be frustrating. Enter Copernic, a powerful search suite which combines the power of the best search engines. The Basic edition of Copernic 2001 is a free download that lets you locate information across seven search categories (Web, newsgroups, e-mail, etc) and 80 information resources, which is more than enough for most of us. It also keeps track of all your searches in the recent past, which can be useful for reference purposes. Browser integration allows you to highlight a term and search it with Copernic's search engine. So the next time you need to round up a Web trip, take a ride on Copernic.

Shareware; www.copernic.com



Music maker

If you have a passion for music and love creating, editing, converting and playing music, then obviously you need a tool that integrates all these needs. MusicMatch Jukebox is an all-in-one music management tool which would satisfy all your ripping, encoding, playing and editing needs. It has an ID3 tag editor, and gives you access to a streaming radio service. The MusicMatch guide informs you about all free music downloads while the super tagging feature helps you tag your files with additional information. MusicMatch Jukebox allows you to record tracks at the bit rate of your choice (up to a whopping 320 Kbps), and you can also customise the looks.

Freeware; www.musicmatch.com



Document reader

A lot of useful information such as manuals, documents and whitepapers are created primarily for print. Adobe's PDF (Portable Document Format) is the most popular format for distributing print documents electronically. To read documents prepared using Adobe's Acrobat software, you will need the free Acrobat Reader software. The latest release, version 5.0, will integrate smoothly with your browser and allow you to view PDF documents online without downloading them to your machine, or save it locally if you choose to. With the ability to zoom documents, navigate using previously created bookmarks, and select text and graphics, this is clearly the best PDF viewer so far.

Freeware; www.adobe.com



Video gaga

Looking for the ultimate video experience? If yes, then PowerDivX is the player for you. Multiple custom aspect ratios allow you to increase or decrease the video viewing area, built-in DivX Codec wipes out the need for additional Codec installations, AC3 Dolby digital and THX is supported for awesome audio reproduction, and, hold on, it even allows you to set CPU utilisation limits—you can control its impact on overall system performance! It also gives you an option to disable screensavers while watching videos while the PowerDivX NextGen features the DiviDivX, which can reproduce DVD menus. This player is waiting to get you experienced. Grab it.

Freeware; www.powerdivx.com